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# Senate of Virginia Floor Session, Wednesday, January 21, 2026

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**[00:04:27]** This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Senate Chamber.

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**[00:10:17]** The Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

**[00:12:23]** This is the Senate of Virginia, Richmond, Virginia, Chamber.

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[00:27:23] chamber be sure to stay connected with live sessions catch up on past meetings

[00:29:15] and explore our full archives any the senate will come to order the senators will please take their seats those persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor will retire to the gallery the senators and all in attendance will please stand if you're able and be led in prayer today by the Reverend Dr. George W.C. Lyons Jr. from Gilfield Baptist Church in Petersburg and the Pledge of

[00:29:48] Allegiance will be performed out there and we will be led in the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America by Senate Page Chance Salt from Stafford. Let us pray.

[00:30:06] Eternal and all-wise God, we pause at the threshold of this session to acknowledge that all wisdom, all justice and all authority ultimately rests in you grant our senators clear vision vision to recognize resources that will strengthen the weak vision to create pathways that will house the vulnerable vision to see not only what is expedient but what is equitable and enduring grant them wisdom to develop budgets that reflect compassion and responsibility as ideas cross

[00:30:45] chambers and conversations cross aisles. Let the exchange of good ideas become great legislation crafted, refined and passed in the best interest of the good people of this commonwealth. We ask your blessing upon Madam President, the Senate leadership, every senator and every member of the staff. Protect their families while they serve and grant health, safety and grace for the work that is before them may this chamber reflect wisdom for decision making courage for just action

[00:31:23] and care for the common good for the common wealth of all virginians we offer this prayer and humble trust and in your righteous name amen i pledge allegiance to the flag of the united states of america and to the republic for which it stands one nation under god indivisible with

[00:31:53] liberty and justice for all the clerk will call the roll all those present will please vote aye

[00:32:49] the clerk will call the roll they do uh the clerk will now close the role uh 40 no zero

[00:33:22] ayes 40 no zero thank you senate journal for tuesday january 20th 2026. senator from central fairfax moves that the reading of the journal be waived all in favor of waiving the reading of the journal will record their vote aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 35

[00:33:59] noes 5. Ayes 35, noes 5. The reading of the journal is waived. The clerk will report any communication from the House of Delegates. We do not have any, Madam President. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Madam President, sorry, I move that I move the reading of the resolution be waived. Thank you, Senator. We will return to that in just a few

[00:34:39] minutes. I withdraw the motion. Thank you. We have now arrived at the morning hour when we will welcome our guests who are visiting us our distinguished guests who are visiting us in the gallery today thank you so much for joining us our procedure is that a senator will rise and welcome our guests with a introduction and following that introduction I will ask that we provide the warm welcome of the

[00:35:14] Senate we will begin today's introductions with the senator from Eastern Henrico County. Thank you so much Madam President. I rise for two introductions. The senator has the floor. Thank you so much Madam President. Madam President and members of the body, it is my pleasure to acknowledge that our invocation was offered today by the Dr. George W.C. Lyons Jr. I mean if he is still present I'd ask that he please stand. He is the senior pastor of the

[00:35:48] historic gillfield baptist church in petersburg virginia uh while a native of los angeles california he has long been here with us here in the commonwealth he has held so many leadership positions on numerous boards and committees but most importantly is his the work that he leads his congregation to do in our local community and so if you would please give him the warm welcome of our Senate. As a reminder to our visitors in the gallery, following the introduction from one

[00:36:27] of our senators, I will say a few words of welcome and then we will applaud together. Thank you so much. Reverend, thank you for joining us and thank you especially for the words of invocation and blessings that you provided this morning. We are delighted to have you today and appreciate your gift of time to us senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate to the reverend

[00:36:53] dr george wc lyons jr the senator has the floor thank you so much madam president further i'd like to also acknowledge the virginia association of personal care providers and i'd ask that they please stand from the gallery madam president we are joined by many of their advocates the association is a statewide organization represented agency directed personal care providers who really

[00:37:27] serve and take care of our elderly and disabled virginians through their advocacy you know i'm so proud that they are elevating the voices of caregivers uh for in those they serve while promoting policies that protect the dignity independence and the quality of life that they allow for so i'd also ask that you give them the warm welcome of the senate thank you senator for that introduction. And thank you to the Virginia Association of Personal Care Reminders for being here today. I hope you've had a wonderful visit to the Capitol and have had good opportunity to meet with and speak to our many legislators. Thank you again for joining us. I ask the

[00:38:06] Senate that we give the warm welcome to our visitors. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purpose of an introduction.

[00:38:26] - The Senator has the floor. - Thank you, Madam President. I'm privileged to introduce the members of the Virginia's 4-H organization, invite them to stand and be recognized. Today, over 450 students are visiting the General Assembly from across our Commonwealth to see the legislative process firsthand. And for more than 100 years, the 4-H has given kids a voice to express who they are and the opportunities and tools to make their lives and communities better, not only locally, but state and federally and internationally.

[00:38:52] Our young people in this program complete projects in areas of health, science, agriculture, and civic engagement. And this year, the national campaign is Beyond Ready. It has the capacity to empower and teach young people to be able to adapt and thrive in a rapidly changing world.

[00:39:08] And I know this is beyond half of everyone and all the 4-H clubs from around the Commonwealth, but we'd be remiss to give a shout out to Prince William and Stafford's 4-H as well. So thank you, Madam President. - Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And thank you for visiting us.

[00:39:24] Prince William County as well as so many other groups of our 4-H organizations. I hope you've had a wonderful visit and hope you continue to have the chance to talk to many of your representatives and share the good work that you are doing through your 4-H programs.

[00:39:42] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Prince William County and other 4-H groups. The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth.

[00:39:59] - Good morning, power to you, Madam President. - Good morning. - Madam President, this morning we were admonished gently, well not so gently in our caucus, that we are to have a little bit of brevity when we make our introductions.

[00:40:19] But I'm gonna ask for an extra minute today. I'll keep it as brief as I can because I have a special guest who's retiring and I need to say a few things about him. On behalf of Senator Craig and myself, today we're pleased to welcome members of the Chesapeake Public Schools School Board, Superintendent Jared Cotton and his leadership team here at the Capitol today.

[00:40:41] Are they standing? Thank you. I would especially like to take this opportunity to recognize and give appreciation for Dr. Cotton who is retiring after this school year. Dr. Cotton has devoted more than three decades to public education, beginning his career as a fifth grade teacher in Chesapeake, serving as superintendent of Henry County Public Schools and ultimately returning home to lead Chesapeake Public Schools in 2018.

[00:41:09] Throughout his tenure, he has led with both expertise and heart, guiding Chesapeake Public Schools through a pandemic while raising students' achievement, expanding career and technical education, and ensuring students graduate college and career ready.

[00:41:25] He also led Chesapeake to become the first school division in Virginia to achieve a 100% Purple Star designation honoring our military families. A trusted partner to the Chesapeake Legislative Delegation, Dr. Cotton's leadership has been recognized statewide, including being named Virginia Superintendent of the Year in 2019 and Region 2 Superintendent of the Year in 2025.

[00:41:53] We're deeply grateful for his extraordinary service and wish him the very best in a well-earned retirement. Chesapeake is stronger because of Dr. Cotton, and I would appreciate if you would extend to him and his team the very warm welcome of the Senate. - I thank the Senator from Portsmouth for that very necessary introduction.

[00:42:13] Clearly the accomplishments and the hard work of our superintendent and many of the staff is so evident in the results that we are seeing. Superintendent, thank you so much for joining us. Thank you for the other guests that are accompanying you today.

[00:42:28] And I ask that the Senate give the warm welcome to our visitors this morning. Thank you.

[00:42:55] chair recognizes the sergeant at arms please receive it good morning madam president it is a pleasure to be here before you today I have been directed by the speaker of the house of delegates to inform the senator that the house has agreed to HJR 74 relating to judicial elections and certain elective officers and requests the concurrence of the Senate the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax County madam president of the reading of the resolution wave the question is shall the reading of the resolution be waived

[00:43:35] all in favor of the motion will say aye those those opposed no the eyes have it the reading is waived the chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax County Madam President I move the rules be suspended in House Joint Resolution number 74 be taken up for immediate consideration the question is shall the rules be suspended and the House Joint Resolution number 74 be taken up for immediate consideration all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any

[00:44:09] senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll eyes 40 no zero eyes 40 nose zero the rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration so you can just guess and you can say as the amendments are being delivered we will continue with our morning hour and uh the chair calls upon the senator from western henrico for the purposes of an introduction

[00:44:49] thank you madam president madam president i rise for the purposes of introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president man president members of the body today we have with us the virginia association of recovery residences if they're here if they please stand um uh var is uh the leader in what is a really important space in this commonwealth of recovery residences and making sure that people get the help that they need so that they can thrive and and kind of re-enter society clean and sober and uh you know we in the general assembly have done a lot of work with them over the years and continue to do work this year and moving forward

[00:45:24] and so i'd hope that we would give them a warm senate applause i thank the senator for that introduction and welcome to the virginia association of recovery residences thank you so much for the work that you do. Thank you for the lives that you have saved and continue to improve. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Virginia Association of Recovery Residences.

[00:45:50] The chair recognizes the senator from Washington. Good morning, Madam President. Good morning. I rise for an introduction, or good afternoon, I guess. I rise for an introduction. The senator has the floor.

[00:46:13] Madam President, members of the Senate, today in the gallery we have a very special guest that I get to hear stories about and see pictures of quite often from my very proud seatmate, her father, and that is Susanna Deeds, if she'll rise for us. Susanna is visiting us from Anchorage, she's a graduate of Longwood and the University of Alaska, and this is the first time she's been back in the chamber since my seatmate was sworn in in 2001 and i know we all would agree that we need to see her more often and i know that my seatmate would like to see her more often here in the

[00:46:53] chamber and and certainly in virginia but if we could all um madam president would be the pleasure that the senate to join in offering her a warm senate welcome i thank the senator for that introduction and want to welcome you, Susanna, to the gallery to visit the work of your father.

[00:47:14] We know that your father is one of our true accomplished leaders in the Senate. We're delighted to have him, delighted to have you visiting all the way from Alaska today, and thank you so much for being here.

[00:47:30] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to Susanna Deeds. The chair calls on the senator from Norfolk.

[00:47:54] Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Today we welcome a group of distinguished visitors to the Capitol.

Joining us are the members of the Hampton Roads Realtors Association who have traveled here from across the Hampton Roads region to be here during this legislative session.

[00:48:19] And I would ask if they're in the gallery, would they stand? These realtors are not only professionals who help Virginians achieve the dream of home ownership, but they are also deeply engaged civic leaders and advocates for their communities.

[00:48:38] Their work supports local economies, strengthens neighborhoods, and helps ensure that housing opportunities remain accessible for families throughout the Commonwealth. Today, they are here to share their perspectives on issues affecting property rights, housing affordability and the vitality of our local communities and to learn more about the work we do on behalf of the people of Virginia.

[00:49:03] We are grateful for their involvement in the legislative process and for them taking the time to engage with us here at the Capitol. I hope it will be the pleasure of this body to give my Realtors Association, the Hampton Roads Realtors Association, the warm welcome of the Senate.

[00:49:22] - I thank the Senator for that introduction welcome indeed to our visitors from the Hampton Roads Realtor Association. I hope you've had productive days here at the Capitol and opportunities to speak with our legislators. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Hampton Roads Realtor Association. The chair calls on the senator from Tazewell. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for the purpose of introduction. The senator has the floor. Madam President, this morning we're happy to have in the

[00:50:01] gallery with us caleb kessner and a group of students from the church homeschool group of smith county this is their first time visiting the capital here in virginia and we're pleased that they could join us with their students to watch their senate in action caleb kessner and his father and his sons are avid bear hunters they harvested several bear through the year quite known in the area for that accomplishment loves to go camping and join the great outdoors

[00:50:37] with family and friends and i would ask that you give them the warm welcome of the senate i thank the senator for that introduction uh bear hunting uh quite quite an accomplishment we're so delighted that you are here today and i hope you have a wonderful opportunity to tour the the Capitol, certainly to meet not only with your senator from Tazewell, but so many of our other legislators.

[00:51:04] Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Buckeye Hollow Church group, homeschool group today. Thank you.

[00:51:19] The chair recognizes the junior senator from Loudoun. Good afternoon, Madam President. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. today in the gallery we are joined by members representing spark also known as specially adapted resource centers may i ask them to raise spark is a non-profit organization dedicated to enriching the lives of adults with severe and multiple disabilities by providing inclusive recreational

[00:51:54] educational and social opportunities that foster independence dignity and community connection through structured programming and in and individualized support spark fills a critical gap in services for adults with complex support needs and their families creating safe engaging spaces where participants can thrive spark serves adults at five locations across northern virginia and they are here in richmond today advocating for greater support to expand and sustain their services i hope you will all join me in extending them a warm welcome of the senate thank you for

[00:52:30] that introduction and welcome indeed to our representatives from SPARC. Thank you so much for the leadership you continue to provide and especially the work that you do in advocacy and support for so many of our students who are benefiting from your remarkable service. Thank you indeed for joining us and Senators I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to our distinguished members representing spark the chair recognizes the senator from charlottesville

[00:53:12] madam president aroused for an introduction the senator has the floor madam president ladies gentlemen of the senate today we are members with us from the virginia academy of clinical psychologists clinical psychology is the specialty that provides continuing and comprehensive mental and behavioral health care for individuals couples families and groups consultation to agencies and communities, training, education, and supervision, and research-based practice.

[00:53:40] The Virginia Association of Clinical Psychologists is the voice of professional clinical psychology within the Commonwealth of Virginia. I would hope that, Madam President, you'd give this group the warm greetings to the Senate. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction.

[00:53:56] Will our representatives from the Virginia Academy of Clinical Psychologists please stand? Thank you so much for joining us today in the gallery. Thank you for the work that you do, such critical and necessary efforts on behalf of the individuals that you serve and take care of.

[00:54:13] I hope you have productive conversations with your legislators throughout this afternoon. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Virginia Academy of Clinical Psychologists.

[00:54:42] Seeing no further introductions, resolutions, petitions, and bills are now in order. chair now recognizes the senator from Richmond. Madam President I request unanimous consent to introduce a bill. The senator has the floor. Thank you madam president. I'm asking for unanimous unanimous consent for a bill relating to charitable gaming and poker events and the second is a bill relating to

[00:55:20] electric and gas utilities rates and charges for service political influence activity promotional advertising annual report the question is shall the senate grant consent to introduce two additional bills a bill relating to gaming and another bill relating to electric utilities all in favor of the motion will say aye those opposed no hearing a fear few clearing of

[00:55:55] the throats but the eyes seem to have it senator the consent of the senate is granted to introduce those two bills we will now return to the house joint resolution number 74 the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax madam president i moved the res no very suspended for media

[00:56:34] consideration we did suspend already okay madam president i move the resolution be agreed to the question is shall the resolution be agreed to all in favor of agreeing to the resolution will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted. Do any senators desire to change their votes? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0. Ayes 39, noes 0. The resolution is agreed to. The chair directs the senator from eastern

[00:57:09] Fairfax County to inform the House of Delegates of the action of the Senate. The Senate will be

[00:57:16] at ease until the return. Good afternoon, Madam President. Good afternoon. Looking good and well,

[00:58:12] madam president thank you madam president i rise for introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president when we talk about health care and affordability in the senate we often talk about legislation and policy in an abstract way but today in the senate we have guests who are on the front line of health care taking care of virginians across the commonwealth i would like to welcome members of the virginia pharmacy association would they please rise these pharmacists and pharmacy technicians are the ones advising virginians making sure their medications doesn't

[00:58:46] have complications to administer vaccines and also care for our communities. Virginia pharmacists are here today to advocate in keeping their doors open and making sure they can continue providing health care to our communities across the Commonwealth. Madam President, will you please extend a warm welcome to the Virginia Pharmacy Association. I thank the senator for that introduction and thank you so much to the Virginia Pharmacists Association for joining us. I know you're representing many of your colleagues all throughout the commonwealth who are working so assiduously on behalf of our communities thank you again for joining us senators i ask that we

[00:59:25] give the warm welcome of the senate to the virginia pharmacists association the chair recognizes the senator from northern fairfax fairfax thank you madam president i write for a rise for an introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president today in the gallery we have an organization that is a true binding group that really helps save so many people in our

[01:00:01] in our in our community cornerstones a non-profit serving our community in fairfax and recently more more recently in loudon if you'd stand up that'd be great um cornerstones helps families and individuals access stable housing strengthen food security and ensure that families and children can thrive. I have volunteered with them over the past 20 years. They are an integral part of our community. I'm so delighted that they're here today doing their good work. And I'd like Madam

[01:00:36] President to give a special acknowledgement to the CEO, Carrie Wilson. She's going to be retiring in 2026 after nearly 25 years of extraordinary leadership and service to our community. And I'm so proud that she's a neighbor and a friend and I ask that you give them the warm welcome of the Senate. I thank the Senator for that introduction and thank you so much to our visitors representing Cornerstones. Congratulations especially to Carrie for your upcoming retirement. Thank you for the work that you have done to help so many in the community. Senators I ask that we give the warm

[01:01:15] welcome of the senate to cornerstones and most especially to kerry wilson the chair calls on the senator senior senator from prince william thank you madam president rise for the purpose of an introduction the senator has the floor thank you madam president i'm honored to introduce today the esteemed members of the virginia fire chiefs association and if they could rise the virginia fire chiefs association is a non-partisan organization that was formed in 1930 with a mission to serve virginia's communities by advancing fire and rescue service through

[01:01:55] leadership education and advocacy and today they're visiting the general assembly to advocate sustainable funding for the local fire service but also the high quality emergency response for every resident and visitor across our great commonwealth of virginia thank you madam president if you could please provide them with the warm welcome of the senate thank you for that introduction senator and thank you to the virginia fire chiefs association thank you for your leadership thank you for your commitment to the various communities that you serve and thank you for the public safety that you provide to each and every one of us senators i ask that we give the warm welcome

[01:02:32] of the senate to the virginia fire chiefs association seeing no further introductions the time for the joint order for certain judicial elections has arrived and the senate on its part is ready to proceed with the execution of H.J.R. House Joint Resolution No. 74.

[01:03:13] Nominations are now in order for the judges of the respective circuit courts. The chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax County. Thank you, Madam President. I move the rules be suspended. The Committee of Courts of Justice be discharged and further consideration of the resolution. The readings of the title will be waived and the Senate Resolution No. 13 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[01:03:33] The question is, shall the rules be suspended? The Committee of Courts for Justice be discharged from further consideration of the resolution, the readings of the title be waived, and Senate Resolution No. 13 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[01:03:51] All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, noes 0.

[01:04:10] Ayes 39, noes 0. The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration. The chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax County. Can the president move the resolution be agreed to?

[01:04:27] The question is, shall the resolution be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The resolution is agreed to. are now in order for the judges of the respective general district courts. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax County. Madam President I move the rules be suspended the committee courts of justice be discharged for the consideration of the resolution the reason the title be waived and the Senate resolution number 14 be taken up for immediate consideration. The question is shall the rules be suspended the committee for courts of justice be

[01:05:06] discharged from further consideration of the resolution the readings of the title be waived and senate resolution number 14 be taken up for immediate consideration as many as are in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the role ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the rules are suspended

[01:05:41] to take up the resolution for immediate consideration The chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax County. Madam President, I move the rules to be suspended. The committee of courts adjust to be discharged for the consideration of the resolution of the reason to be waived and that the Senate resolution number 15 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[01:06:07] Senator, we need to first move the resolution number 14. I'm sorry, I move the resolution to be agreed to. I'm sorry. So, senators, we are agreeing to the resolution number 14. The question is, shall the resolution be agreed to? All in favor of the motion, we'll say aye.

[01:06:23] any opposed no the ayes have it the resolution is agreed to senator now nominate from the house please receive it thank you madam president i've been directed by the speaker of the house of delegates to inform the senate the house has made certain nominations pursuant to hjr 74

[01:07:02] and requests to concurrence of the senate nominations are now in order for the judges of the respective juvenile and domestic relations district courts the chair again recognizes the Senator from

Eastern Fairfax County.

[01:07:33] Thank you, Madam President. Sorry for the earlier malfunction. I move the rules be suspended. The Committee of Courts of Justice be discharged from further consideration of the resolution. The readings of the title be waived and Senate Resolution Number 15 be taken up for immediate consideration. Thank you, Senator. The question is, shall the rules be suspended, the Committee for Courts of Justice be discharged from further consideration of the resolution, the readings of the title be waived, and Senate Resolution Number 15 be taken up for immediate consideration as many as are in favor of the motion will record their votes aye

[01:08:05] those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration the chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax move the resolution be agreed to the question is shall the resolution be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye any

[01:08:40] opposed no the eyes have it the resolution is agreed to nominations are now in order for a member of the state corporation Commission the chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville madam president I move the rules be suspended the committee on commerce and labor be discharged from From further consideration of the resolution, the readings of the title be waived and Senate Resolution No. 16 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[01:09:12] The question is, shall the rules be suspended, the Committee on Commerce and Labor be discharged from further consideration of the resolution, the readings of the title be waived, and Senate Resolution No. 16 be taken up for immediate consideration.

[01:09:29] As many as are in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Does any senator desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, no zero. Ayes 40, no zero. The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration. The chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the resolution be agreed to. The question The question is, shall the resolution be agreed to?

[01:10:07] As many as are in favor of agreeing to the resolution will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The resolution is agreed to. Nominations are now in order for a member of the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission.

[01:10:27] The chair again recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move that the rules be suspended. The Committee on Commerce and Labor be discharged from further consideration of the resolution. the readings of the title be waived and Senate resolution number 17 be taken up for immediate consideration. The question is, shall the rules be suspended, the Committee on Commerce and Labor be discharged from further consideration of the resolution, the readings of the title be waived and Senate resolution number 17 be taken up for immediate consideration. As many as are in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote?

[01:11:07] Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 39, no 0. Ayes 39, no 0.

[01:11:23] The rules are suspended to take up the resolution for immediate consideration. The chair recognizes the senator from Charlottesville. Madam President, I move the resolution be agreed to. The question is, shall the resolution be agreed to? As many as are in favor of agreeing to the resolution will say aye.

[01:11:42] Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The resolution is agreed to. The chair directs the senator from eastern Fairfax County to inform the House of Delegates of the nominations that have been made by the Senate.

[01:12:01] We return again to the morning hour, and the chair recognizes the senator from Hampton. Thank you, Madam President. I rise for an introduction.

[01:12:21] The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Earlier today, I joined members of this body and the body down the hall to announce the launch of an HBCU caucus. As a proud two-time HBCU alum, I'm honored to serve as co-chair of the caucus. Virginia is home to five HBCUs, three private and two public, that educate, employ, and uplift communities throughout the state.

[01:12:44] Joining us in the gallery today are the presidents and students from all five HBCUs. General Darrell Williams, President of Hampton University, Dr. McCullough Abdullah, President of Virginia State University, Dr. Kathy Franklin, President of Virginia University of Lynchburg, Dr. Hakeem Lucas, President of Virginia Union University, and Dr. Javon Adams-Gaston, President of Norfolk State University.

[01:13:11] Madam President, I ask we give them the warm welcome of the Senate. I thank you for that introduction and welcome to our presidents who represent such vital institutions. Our Virginia HBCUs play such an important role throughout the Commonwealth. We thank you for the work you do with our students and we thank you for the service to the Commonwealth and delighted that we have the Virginia HBCU caucus visiting us here today now. Senators, I ask that we

[01:13:39] We give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Virginia HBCU caucus. The chair recognizes the Senator from Eastern Henrico.

[01:14:00] Thank you, Madam Chair. I rise for an introduction. The Senator has the floor. Thank you so much. Madam President, it's my pleasure to recognize a delegation visiting us today from the city of Hopewell and I would ask that they would please stand. Madam President, this delegation includes members of the city government, the school board, the city council, and they are all seated in the gallery.

[01:14:20] Madam President, located where the Appomattox and James Rivers meet, Hopewell has long been a gateway for commerce, industry, and innovation, helping to shape the Commonwealth's economic and civic history. And these amazing guests that are part of the delegation all have an integral role in ensuring that Hopewell remains alive, vibrant, and continues to grow -- vibrant, excuse me, and continues to grow.

[01:14:41] So I would ask that we would give them the warm welcome of the Senate. Senator, thank you for that introduction and a warm welcome to all of our visitors from the city of Hopewell. Thank you for the work you are doing in the community and the representation that you are providing here today for Hopewell.

[01:15:00] I hope you have a wonderful day at the Capitol. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to representatives from the city of Hopewell. The chair recognizes the senator from

Northern Fairfax.

[01:15:20] Thank you, Madam President. I rise for a second introduction. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. My understanding is that we have a group of families in the gallery. They are homeschoolers of Virginia's United Against Government Oversight, and I ask that you give them a warm Senate welcome.

[01:15:44] It's good to have folks who are taking time, coming to Richmond, speaking their voice, and I appreciate that. I appreciate you giving them a welcome. Thank you, Senator, for that introduction. And welcome to the Homeschoolers of Virginia United Against Government Oversight.

[01:16:03] Thank you so much for being here and for speaking to your representatives and sharing your insights and perspectives. Senators, I ask that we give the warm welcome of the Senate to the Homeschoolers of Virginia.

[01:16:35] The chair recognizes the chair, the senator from King George. Thank you, Madam President. Good afternoon. I almost said morning. Rise for an introduction, Madam President. The senator has the floor.

[01:16:50] Thank you, Madam President. You may not have a green sheet on this, but it is my pleasure to bring to the attention of the members the presence in the gallery of a very good friend of mine sitting up there, Mr. T.C. Collins. He dedicated his life to serving the public and protecting all of us and the Virginia State Police.

[01:17:13] Not too long ago retired, and he's the past chairman of the board for the King George County Supervisors And he's just done an extraordinary job for the citizens of King George. I was very sad to see him retire He's here today to testify on a bill Of the difficulties he has had with a gigantic corporation So you're gonna get to hear that in general laws if you're on that committee And I'm just delighted that he had, what do I call that, the intestinal fortitude to fight these corporations and bring it to the General Assembly so we can hopefully rectify that.

[01:17:50] Madam President, I would ask that you give Mr. Collins the warm welcome of the Senate. Thank you for that introduction and a warm welcome to you, Mr. Collins. thank you so much for joining us and thank you for being here to advocate and champion on legislation that you you feel so uh to be so important thank you for adding your voice to the discussion today

[01:18:15] senators i ask that we give the warm welcome of the senate to mr t.c collins we return now

[01:18:55] to the senate resolutions all in favor of the nominees of the senate as named by senate resolution number 13 to be judges of the respective circuit courts will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero all in favor

[01:19:31] of the nominees of the senate as named by senate resolution number 14 to be judges of the respective general district courts will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the resolution is agreed to all in favor of the nominees of the senate as named by senate resolution number 15 to be judges of the respective

[01:20:08] juvenile and domestic relations district courts will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their vote the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no zero the resolution is agreed to as many as are in favor of the nominee of the senate as named by senate resolution number 16 to be a member of the state corporation commission will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready

[01:20:45] to vote have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the roll ayes 40 no zero ayes 40 no nay zero senate resolution number 16 is agreed to as many as are in favor of the nominee of the senate as named by senate resolution number 17 to be a member of the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission, will record their votes aye, those

[01:21:18] opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate resolution number 17 is agreed to. The chair now appoints senators, the senator from Arlington, the senator from Central Fairfax and the senator from Colonial Heights to the committee on the part of the Senate

[01:21:52] to count and report the vote of each house in each case. We will stand at ease until the committee

[01:21:59] returns. The joint order under the House Joint Resolution No. 74 will be resumed. The clerk

[01:27:58] will read the report of the committee to count the vote. The committee has reported as follows. number of votes necessary to elect in the House of Delegates, 51, in the Senate, 21. The chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax County.

[01:28:17] I threw away my script, but I think I'm supposed to waive the reading of the report. Yes, senator. The question is, shall the reading of the report be waived? All in favor of the motion will record their votes, aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:28:33] Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their vote? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 37, noes 1. Ayes 37, noes 1.

[01:28:49] The reading of the report is waived. Those named in the report as having received the vote of a majority of the members elected to each house of the General Assembly are declared duly elected. as judges of the respective circuit courts, general district courts, and juvenile and domestic relations district courts, as a member of the State Corporation Commission, and as a member of the Virginia Workers' Compensation Commission for the terms that have been set forth. Is there

[01:29:28] any other business to come? The clerk will call the calendar. Set a calendar for Wednesday, January 21st, 2026. Uncontested calendar, Senate Bill on third reading. Senate Bill 95, a bill relating to rest area signage, human trafficking information. The chair calls on the senator from Prince, Western Prince William. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I rise to move passage of the bill. The senator has the floor. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I moved to pass the

[01:30:07] bill. This is on the uncontested calendar. The very short version of this is this makes sure that we have QR codes and other information to further enhance how to self-identify signs of human trafficking on interstate rest stops.

[01:30:23] The question is, shall Senate Bill 95 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye, those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to

change their votes?

[01:30:41] The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 40, noes 0. Ayes 40, noes 0. Senate Bill 95 passes. Regular calendar, Senate Bill's on third reading.

[01:30:59] Senate Bill 67, a bill relating to parking enforcement issuance of a summons or parking ticket. The chair recognizes the senator from York.

[01:31:15] Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill passes. I'm speaking to the bill. senator has the floor. Thank you. This bill is about removing a population requirement for those localities wishing to contract their parking enforcement. Essentially we're looking for the city of Williamsburg to be able to do this and their population being less than 40,000 only 16,000.

[01:31:39] I initially had thought of doing a clause that said a locality having a tourist visitation of more than 2 million but after doing some research I'd found that over the years this bill had been amended four times for various population brackets raising ranging from 390,000 to 100 to 130,000 and down to 40,000 so in an effort to make this so we don't have to continually come back to this over the years I hope that it's a good idea to remove the population bracket all

[01:32:16] together realizing that most localities with a small population would not be taking on a contract to do their parking in fact I came from a locality York County of 80,000 and we had no idea whatsoever to ever contract out our parking because it was not a problem and I think many other localities are in the the same vote so i would ask you to uh please vote for the bill the question is shall senate bill

[01:32:51] 67 pass all in favor of the motion will record their votes aye those opposed no are the senators ready to vote have have all the senators voted do any senators desire to change their votes the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 31, noes 9. Ayes 31, noes 9. The bill passes.

[01:33:16] Senate Bill 81. A bill relating to enforcement of federal traffic information infractions by state and local law enforcement officers photo speed monitoring devices planning district 8.

[01:33:35] The chair recognizes the senator from eastern Fairfax. Thank you Madam President. I move the the bill passed and speaking to that motion the senator has the floor thank you madam president ladies gentlemen senate senate bill 81 is uh close except for about four words to the bill that we passed last session um and uh it basically applies to about eight miles of road uh near my house along the potomac river the george washington memorial parkway and then another 14 mile stretch that runs from uh northern alexandria up to uh 495 along the river um it was basically designed as a scenic

[01:34:10] highway to sort of drive down along the river on your way to George Washington's house and admire the river in the last 50 years it's turned into a major commuter thoroughfare with high volumes and a lot of a lot of cars on it and consequently since the last background in 2005 a lot of car accidents the United States Park Police has stopped basically stopped policing the road which I can get into if anybody wants to know why but the Fairfax County Police and the state police don't have authority to police the road right now because it's a part of a national

[01:34:45] park. And basically this law would allow the Fairfax County police or the Virginia state police to go out there and write traffic summonses and then bring them in state court instead of federal court where they're currently brought. In addition to that, it allows the state police or the county police, if the National Park Service will agree, to install speed cameras on the road if they can reach an agreement.

[01:35:08] It basically relates to a very, very, very, very small piece of road in the state. Basically only affects, I think, my district and maybe the senator from Arlington, a little bit of a senator from Fairfax, nobody else. And I would hope we could – senator from Alexandria, yeah.

[01:35:24] So I would hope we could pass the bill so that we can make sure people stay safe. Because right now the road is basically unpoliced. The park police, I asked them for a meeting in September after we didn't pass the bill last year, And they basically refused to meet with me and said, we don't have time to focus on your part of our park. Go away.

[01:35:40] I can give you the memo if you want to see it. So I hope we can pass the bill. The chair recognizes the senator from Lynchburg. Thank you, Madam President. I rise to see if the patron will rise for several questions.

[01:35:58] Will the senator from Eastern Fairfax yield? Thank you, Madam President. For the senator from Eastern Fairfax, my ears perked up when I heard speed cameras. Speed cameras. All right. Who will be operating the speed cameras? The Senator will direct questions to the Chair.

[01:36:18] Madam President, my inquiry would be, amongst the first of several questions, who will be responsible for operating the speed cameras? The Senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I would tell the Senator that if the Park Service were able to reach an agreement with either the state police or the county police, it would depend what the contract says.

[01:36:40] so it could i assume it could either be the county police the state police or a third-party vendor or perhaps the park service the the park service congressman buyer has tried to get the park service to consider putting them in themselves but the problem is under current federal law if there's any revenue recovered from the cameras they would go straight into the federal general fund or whatever they call the general fund is at the federal level and so they would have to pay for the cameras but would have no means of recovering the cost of them so the park service been unwilling to do it so that's why i did this as a possible workaround if the park service could reach an agreement they could figure it out so that's the best way i can answer it depends what

[01:37:17] the contract says the chair calls on the senator from lynchburg further follow up i would just and apparently very uncertain at this point but if the senator knows if the state or locality operates it how the funding would be divided who would receive the funding and would it be mandated to go to a particular area, such as back to the law enforcement.

[01:37:44] The senator from Eastern Fairfax has the floor. Madam President, I would just tell the senator that the bill doesn't restrict where the money could go, and so I think the parties would be free to figure out how to allocate the revenue in whatever contract they enter into. So if the county were to enter the contract, they could agree to split it with the Park Service or give it solely to the county or whatever, or if the state police were to do it.

[01:38:07] I'm sure the state police would want to cover the cost of the program, and they would be free to contract that but the bill doesn't direct it to go anywhere. Senator from Lynchburg. Madam President I thank the senator and I would speak briefly to the bill. Senator has the floor. Thank you and I know it's it's early in the session but I have a spectacular bill two bills that I have brought this year that will be heard in committee. I'm sure it will probably meet a swift death this term this session but we have some other bills coming from the house.

[01:38:44] Being on the Virginia Crime Commission, we received a report this year that was truly astounding as to what some localities are doing to generate revenue with the speed cameras.

[01:39:01] Suffolk County, I will go ahead and point them out as we did in the Virginia Crime Commission. I don't know what the population of Suffolk is, but it is the highest, they're the county that generates the highest revenue from speed cameras. $8 million one year and I think $7 million another year for a total of $16 million in two years.

[01:39:24] Higher than any of our other grossly populated areas, much higher than Fairfax County and city. And of course, Alexandria was up there with $1 million. Chesapeake, also another, generating a tremendous amount of money.

[01:39:40] Something about the Hampton Roads, Tidewater area, they seem to really generate a lot for the localities. And I hope the General Assembly and the Senate in particular will pay attention to this tax revenue.

[01:39:56] Localities are attacking people who are driving through their locality. They're mailing these things to them. If they dare show up in court to contest whether or not they were the driver or whether or not they were speeding, there's some of these mandatory extra $250 court fee just for showing up in court in person to protect your constitutional rights.

[01:40:24] And so anything that has these new camera speeds or red light cameras, I would ask the General Assembly to pay a special attention to. Thank you, Madam President. Thank you. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax.

[01:40:40] Thank you, Madam President. If nobody else desires to speak, speaking to the bill. Senator, may proceed. Thank you, Madam President. I appreciate the comments from the senator from Lynchburg. I likewise sit on the crime commission and heard the exact same report. And some of the numbers, particularly I think out of Suffolk, were really huge.

[01:41:00] And it's clear that there's some localities that are strategically placing these things, mainly some towns, I think. think but well suffolk was big but there's some towns and others that are placing these cameras and some places to generate revenue and that report made clear that other states have allocated the revenue to specific purposes and that makes a lot of sense i want to say that with regard to this this this is a very very small problem in a very small part of the commonwealth involving about uh eight miles or about 22 miles of road actually and um i would just ask that uh that

[01:41:37] whole mess not be incorporated into this mess. The only people that are going to yell, the only person that's going to get yelled out about this bill is probably me and maybe the senator from Alexander and the senator from Arlington, maybe. But I don't think anybody else can be bothered by this one because this isn't generally applicable across the whole state. It's just Arlington loves it, I hear. So, and people in my district love it and are begging for it because nobody's enforcing the law out there and it's very dangerous. A lot of people are actually getting, we usually get about one or two people killed per year out on this road because of no policing. So I would hope we

[01:42:09] get past this. Seeing no further discussion, the question is, shall Senate Bill 81 pass? All in favor of the motion will record their votes aye. Those opposed no. Are the senators ready to vote? Have all the senators voted? Do any senators desire to change their votes?

[01:42:34] the clerk will close the roll. Ayes 26, noes 14. Ayes 26, noes 14. Senate Bill 81 passes. Uncontested calendar, Senate bills on second reading. The chair recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that all the Senate bills on second reading.

[01:43:03] On the uncontested calendar on pages three through six, Senate bills 86 through 303 be advanced than Grossman and third reading in the block after the adoption of amendments there to any senator desiring move a bill from the block, please do so after the clerk has read the number of the bill. The question is, shall all Senate bills on second reading on the uncontested calendar on pages three through six, Senate Bill 86 through Senate Bill 303, be engrossed and advanced to their third reading in the block after the adoption of the amendments thereto, and that any senator desiring to remove a bill from the block will do so after the clerk has read the

[01:43:41] number of the bill. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will read the number of the bills. Senate Bill 86 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. Senate Bill 111 reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. Senate Bill 116 reported from the Committee on Local Government. Senate Bill 127 reported the committee on local government with amendments the chair recognizes the senator from mecklenburg

[01:44:18] madam president i move that the amendments be agreed to the question is shall the amendments be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the amendments from the committee on local government are agreed to senator from mecklenburg madam president i move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading

[01:44:51] thanks senate bill 146 reported from the committee for courts of justice senate bill 153 reported from the committee on local government senate bill 179 reported from the committee on local government senate bill 281 reported from the committee on local government senate bill 280 with a substitute senate bill 289 reported from the committee on local government with the substitute the chair recognizes the senator from eastern

[01:45:28] and henrico thank you madam president i move the committee substitute the question is shall the committee substitute the committee the substitute from the committee on local government be agreed to all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the substitute from the committee on local government is agreed to senate bill 303 reported from the committee on local government the question is shall the bills be engrossed and advanced to their third reading

[01:46:01] all in favor of the motion will say aye any opposed no the ayes have it the bills are engrossed and advanced to their third reading regular calendar senate bills on second reading senate bill 18 a bill relating to children adjudication of delinquency reported from the committee for courts of justice with amendment the chair recognizes the senator from Hampton thank you madam president I move that the amendment be agreed to the question is shall the amendment from the committee for courts of justice be

[01:46:39] agreed to all in favor of the motion will will say aye any opposed no the eyes have it the amendment from the committee for courts of justice is agreed to the senator from Hampton thank you madam president I move the Senate Bill 18 be engrossed in advance to its third reading? The question is, shall Senate Bill 18 be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 18 is engrossed in advance to its third reading.

[01:47:15] Senate Bill 44 relating to registration by localities of cemeteries on private property planning district 8 reported for the committee on local government the chair calls on the senator from Western Prince William Western Prince William thank you senator thank you madam president madam president I move engrossment of the bail and pass it on to its third an advancement to its third constitutional reading the question is so shall Senate bill 44 be engrossed in advance to its third reading all in favor of the motion will say aye

[01:47:50] any opposed no the ayes have it the Senate bill 44 is engrossed in advance to his third reading. Senate Bill 77, a bill relating to repairs or maintenance of property, entering adjoining property, petition for entry.

[01:48:09] Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with a substitute. The Chair calls on the Senator from Western Henrike. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move the committee substitute. The question is, shall the committee substitute, the substitute from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The committee substitute is agreed to. The Senator from Western Henrico.

[01:48:37] Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, members of the body, I move that the bill be engrossed in advance to its third reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 77 be engrossed in advance to its third reading? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. Senate Bill 77 is engrossed in advance to its third reading.

[01:48:57] Senate Bill 107, a bill relating to exemptions from jury service upon request, certain caretakers of persons with serious health conditions. Reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice with amendments. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax.

[01:49:15] Thank you, Madam President. I move that the committee amendment be agreed to. The question is, shall the amendments from the Committee for Courts of Justice be agreed to? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it.

[01:49:31] The committee's amendment is agreed to. The senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move SB 107 be engrossed in advance to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 107 be engrossed in advance to its third reading?

[01:49:48] in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 107 is engrossed and advanced. Senate Bill 137, a bill relating to obstructing health care facility access penalties reported from the Committee for Courts of Justice. The chair recognizes the senator from Western Fairfax. Thank you, Madam President. I move that the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third constitutional reading. The question is, shall Senate Bill 137 be engrossed and advanced to

[01:50:26] his third constitutional reading. All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. Senate Bill 137 is engrossed and advanced. Uncontested calendar, Senate Bill on first reading. Senate Bill 96, a bill relating to income tax credit braille labeling program. The chair now recognizes the senator from Eastern Fairfax. Inquiry of the clerk, does that complete today's

[01:51:00] Calendar? Yes, sir. Excellent. Is there any other business to come before the Senate? The clerk will report any announcements on the desk. Today, Wednesday, January 21st, the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet 30 minutes after adjournment, Senate Room A, GAB. The Committee on General Laws

and Technology will meet 30 minutes after adjournment, Senate Room B, GAB. The General Laws and Technology Subcommittee on Housing will meet immediately upon adjournment of General Laws

[01:51:38] and Technology in Senate room B, GAB. Tomorrow, Thursday, January the 22nd, the Hampton Roads Caucus will meet at 7:30 a.m. in the House North Conference Room, Room 700B, General Assembly Building.

[01:51:54] The Finance and Appropriations Subcommittee on Health and Human Resources will meet at 7:30 a.m. in the Senate Finance and Appropriations Room, 13th Floor, GAB. The Committee on Education and Health meet at 8:30 a.m. in Senate Room A, GAB. The Democratic Caucus will meet at 11:15 a.m., Senate Room 1, Capitol. The Republican Caucus will meet at 11:30 a.m. in Senate Room 2 of the Capitol. The chair recognizes the senior senator from Virginia Beach. Thank you, Madam President.

[01:52:33] I rise for the purpose of an announcement. The senator has the floor. Madam President and members of the Senate, tomorrow morning and each Thursday morning during session, the aerospace and aviation caucus will meet at 8 a.m in senate committee room 600b in the general assembly building this is a change from last year we're hoping for robust participation now that the meeting is back in the general assembly building as you know aerospace and aviation is an important sector of the commonwealth and impacts all of our districts the aviation aerospace caucus is bipartisan bicameral as co-chaired by as co-chair of the caucus i invite you to participate please

[01:53:11] come for all all of our or part of our meetings and uh that's the schedule so we'll see you tomorrow morning thank you thank you senator the chair recognizes the senator from eastern fairfax uh thank you madam president um the rest of an announcement the senator has the floor uh thank you madam president ladies and gentlemen i just wanted to know for everybody that um appreciate everybody's working on with the judicial elections today which i thought went pretty smoothly for the next judicial elections i've talked to the chairman of the house courts of justice committee

[01:53:48] And we would like every delegation to have their picks for any empty spots figured out by February the 28th so that we have time to interview them in time for the second judicial election. And for those of you who have circuits that have new positions, we're still trying to ascertain whether there's going to be funding for that or not.

[01:54:11] So just be aware of that. You know, we have a tight budget this year, and I think there's either five or six new positions. New judgeship, I think, costs a couple hundred thousand. Appellate judgeships cost $300,000 each.

[01:54:27] You know, collectively, we're looking at the courts asking another $5 or $10 million, which is a lot of money in this budget environment. So just, if you have any newly created positions, make sure you talk to me about it because we're not sure whether they're going to be doing that this year, next year, et cetera. So, but if you have an existing spot, have your pick by February 28th, figure it out.

[01:54:47] Just want everybody to know that as soon as possible. Thank you, Madam President. - The chair recognizes the senator from Portsmouth. Thank you, Madam President. Madam President, I move that the Senate do now adjourn until 12 noon on tomorrow.

[01:55:03] The question is, shall the Senate adjourn until 12 noon tomorrow? All in favor of the motion will say aye. Any opposed, no. The ayes have it. The Senate stands adjourned until 12 noon tomorrow. My mic, we're having problems with it, and I can tell a difference because I don't feel like...

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